ACADEMIC CENTRAL

PRACTICE EXAMINATION

# GRADE 7

# SOCIAL SCIENCES

## PRACTICE EXAM 1

**MARKS: 100** **TIME: 2 hours**

**Section A: Geography (50) – map skills, earthquakes, volcanoes and floods, natural resources and population. Section B: History (50) – the Kingdom of Mali and Timbuktu, the transatlantic slave trade and the colonisation of the Cape.**

Written by Academic Central for practice, following the CAPS curriculum for Grade 7. It is not a Department of Basic Education examination paper.

## INSTRUCTIONS AND INFORMATION

1. This question paper consists of TWO sections: SECTION A: Geography (50 marks) and SECTION B: History (50 marks).
2. Answer ALL the questions in BOTH sections.
3. Number your answers exactly as the questions are numbered.
4. Read the sources carefully before you answer the questions on them. The sources were written for this examination and are based on historical facts.
5. Write in full sentences where explanations are asked for.

## SECTION A: GEOGRAPHY

## QUESTION 1: MAP SKILLS

**1.1** Give ONE term for each description.

1.1.1 The imaginary line at 0° latitude

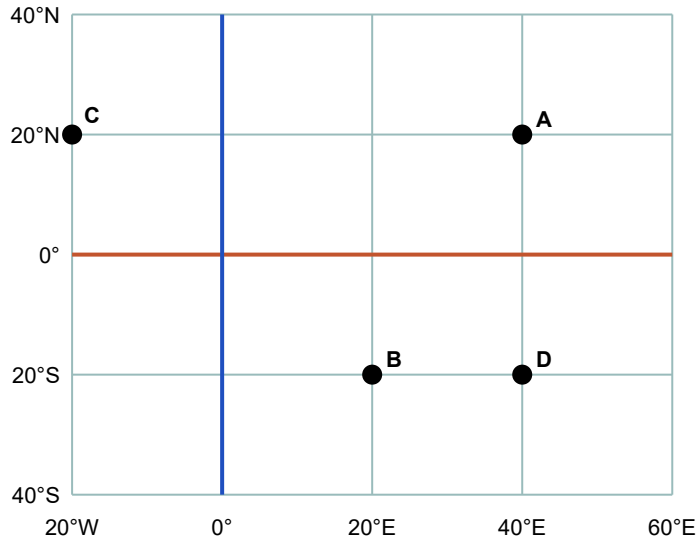
1.1.2 The imaginary line at 0° longitude

1.1.3 Another name for lines of latitude

1.1.4 Half of the Earth

1.1.5 The direction exactly halfway between north and east (5)

**1.2** Study the grid of latitude and longitude lines.




1.2.1 Give the latitude and longitude of point A. (2)

1.2.2 Give the latitude and longitude of point B. (2)

1.2.3 Which point is found at 20°S 40°E? (1)

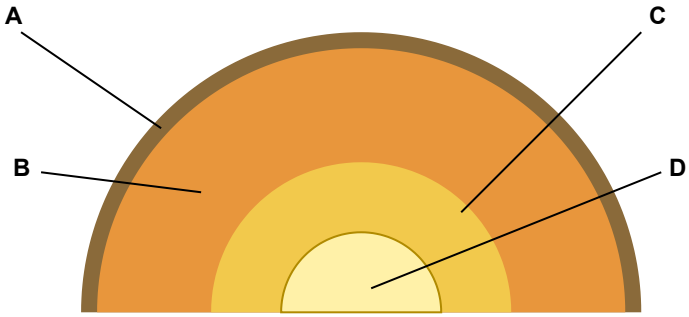
1.2.4 In which TWO hemispheres is point B found? (2)

**1.3** A map has a scale of 1 : 100 000. (a) Explain what this scale means. (b) The distance between two towns on this map is 7,5 cm. What is the real distance in kilometres? (3)

**[15]**

## QUESTION 2: EARTHQUAKES, VOLCANOES AND FLOODS

**2.1** Study the diagram of the inside of the Earth and identify layers A, B, C and D.




Not drawn to scale. A is the thin outer layer.

**2.2** Explain what causes an earthquake. (3)

**2.3** What is the *epicentre* of an earthquake? (2)

**2.4** Name the scale that is used to measure the strength (magnitude) of an earthquake. (1)

**2.5** Give TWO effects that a strong earthquake can have on people. (2)

**2.6** Explain the difference between *magma* and *lava*. (2)

**2.7** Give TWO natural causes and ONE human cause of floods. (3)

**2.8** Give TWO things a community can do to be better prepared for floods. (2)

**2.9** Which South African province was hit by severe floods in April 2022? (1)

**[20]**

## QUESTION 3: NATURAL RESOURCES AND POPULATION

**3.1** Classify each resource as renewable or non-renewable: (a) coal; (b) water; (c) gold; (d) wind. (4)

**3.2** What is meant by *conservation*? (2)

**3.3** Name ONE national park in South Africa and give ONE reason why national parks are important. (2)

**3.4** (a) Name TWO endangered animals in South Africa. (b) Give TWO reasons why animals become endangered. (4)

**3.5** (a) What is meant by *birth rate*? (b) Give TWO reasons why the population grows quickly in some countries. (3)

**[15]**

**TOTAL SECTION A: [50]**

## SECTION B: HISTORY

## QUESTION 4: THE KINGDOM OF MALI AND TIMBUKTU

Read Source A and answer the questions.

> **SOURCE A: Mansa Musa's journey**
>
> In 1324 Mansa Musa, the ruler of Mali, set out on a pilgrimage to Mecca. He travelled with thousands of people and many camels carrying gold. When he passed through Cairo in Egypt, he gave away and spent so much gold that its value there fell for several years. On his return, Mansa Musa brought scholars and builders back to Mali. They helped to make Timbuktu a famous centre of learning, with mosques, libraries and the Sankore school, where students studied religion, law, mathematics and astronomy.

**4.1** Who was the ruler of Mali mentioned in Source A? (1)

**4.2** In which year did he begin his pilgrimage? (1)

**4.3** To which city was he travelling? (1)

**4.4** What happened to the value of gold in Cairo, and why did this happen? (2)

**4.5** What does this tell us about the wealth of the Kingdom of Mali? (2)

**4.6** Name TWO subjects that students studied at Sankore. (2)

**4.7** Explain how the gold–salt trade worked in the Mali Empire. (4)

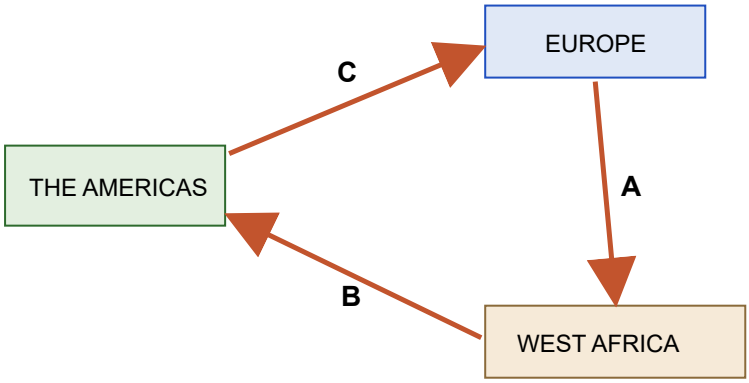
**4.8** Why were camels so important for trade across the Sahara Desert? (2)

**4.9** Why are the old manuscripts of Timbuktu important today? (2)

**[17]**

## QUESTION 5: THE TRANSATLANTIC SLAVE TRADE

**5.1** The diagram shows the triangular trade. Write down what was carried along each route A, B and C.




(3)

**5.2** What was the "Middle Passage"? (2)

**5.3** Describe TWO conditions that enslaved people suffered on the ships. (2)

**5.4** Give TWO effects that the slave trade had on Africa. (2)

**5.5** (a) In which year did Britain end its slave trade? (b) In which year were enslaved people at the Cape freed (although they still had to work as "apprentices")? (2)

**5.6** Name TWO people or groups who fought to end slavery. (2)

**5.7** Why do you think it is important for learners today to learn about the transatlantic slave trade? Give THREE reasons. (3)

**[16]**

## QUESTION 6: THE COLONISATION OF THE CAPE

Read Source B and answer the questions.

> **SOURCE B: The Dutch at the Cape**
>
> In 1652 the Dutch East India Company (VOC) sent Jan van Riebeeck to Table Bay to build a refreshment station. Ships travelling between Europe and the East needed fresh water, vegetables and meat. At first the Dutch traded copper, beads and tobacco with the Khoikhoi for cattle and sheep. In 1657 the VOC gave land along the Liesbeek River to a small group of "free burghers" so that they could farm for themselves. The Khoikhoi had used this land to graze their cattle for many generations, and the first war between the Khoikhoi and the Dutch broke out in 1659.

**6.1** Why did the VOC set up a refreshment station at the Cape? (2)

**6.2** What did the Dutch give the Khoikhoi in exchange for cattle and sheep? (2)

**6.3** Who were the free burghers? (2)

**6.4** Explain why giving land to the free burghers led to conflict with the Khoikhoi. (2)

**6.5** Krotoa (also called Eva) played an important role in the early years of the Cape. Who was she, and what did she do? (2)

**6.6** Enslaved people were brought to the Cape by the VOC. Name TWO places they were brought from. (2)

**6.7** Who were the trekboers, and how did their movement into the interior affect the San? (3)

**6.8** Give TWO reasons why the Khoikhoi lost their independence in the 1700s. (2)

**[17]**

**TOTAL SECTION B: [50]**

**TOTAL: 100**

**END OF QUESTION PAPER**